AFRICAN SOLIDARITY CIVIC ORGANISATION (ASCO)
Registered NPC: 2026/521895/08
SARS Approved PBO: 930092287
Section 18A approved: 9 October 2026
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CORPORATE CSI PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Telkom Foundation × ASCO

Connected Youth for Community Opportunity: Digital Inclusion and Civic Skills Hubs

Requested CSI investment: R100,000

Proposed implementation area: Proposed: one underserved South African school/ community site, prioritising a rural Limpopo location or another site selected with Telkom Foundation after feasibility and eligibility confirmation. Limpopo is a proposal choice informed by Telkom's documented rural-Limpopo ICT-lab example, not a confirmed funding location.

Prepared: October 2026

Confidential proposal for corporate CSI / ESG consideration. This document presents a proposed partnership and does not represent an award, endorsement, existing partnership or company commitment.

Executive summary

ASCO is seeking a strategic corporate CSI partnership with **Telkom Foundation** to support a measurable public-benefit initiative: **Connected Youth for Community Opportunity: Digital Inclusion and Civic Skills Hubs**. The proposed request is **R100,000**, to be applied to direct programme delivery, participation access, safety, learning materials, monitoring and accountable reporting.

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

> **The proposal in one sentence:** Connected Youth for Community Opportunity: Digital Inclusion and Civic Skills Hubs in Proposed: one underserved South African school/community site, prioritising a rural Limpopo location or another site selected with Telkom Foundation after feasibility and eligibility confirmation. Limpopo is a proposal choice informed by Telkom's documented rural-Limpopo ICT-lab example, not a confirmed funding location., benefiting Proposed: disadvantaged secondary-school learners (especially Grades 10-12), out-of-school or unemployed youth, educators and nearby community members, with intentional participation by girls and young women; final numbers and eligibility to be agreed with Telkom Foundation. through a locally designed, monitored and reportable intervention aligned with Telkom Foundation's publicly documented priorities, subject to the company's confirmation of eligibility and application requirements.

What ASCO is requesting
R100,000 in CSI support, or a partial/in-kind contribution structured with the company.

What the funding would enable
Direct activities, participation access, safe delivery, community materials, monitoring and a close-out report.

About ASCO

ASCO is a community-focused civic organisation promoting social justice, community development, active citizenship, African unity, environmental sustainability, inclusion and sustainable public-benefit action. ASCO works through advocacy, education, grassroots initiatives, humanitarian and community-development activities, partnerships and practical interventions.

ASCO is governed by four Directors. The Board governs and Executive Management manages. ASCO maintains governance, donation, safeguarding, financial-management, data-protection, monitoring and reporting instruments for responsible partnership administration.

ASCO's primary contact for this proposal is:

Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu
Executive Director
African Solidarity Civic Organisation (ASCO)
PBO Reference: 930092287
Tel: +27 76 757 5773
Website: https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/

The proposed project

Project title
Connected Youth for Community Opportunity: Digital Inclusion and Civic Skills Hubs

Implementation period
Proposed 6–12 month pilot, with final schedule agreed after eligibility, baseline and permissions are confirmed.

Location
Proposed: one underserved South African school/community site, prioritising a rural Limpopo location or another site selected with Telkom Foundation after feasibility and eligibility confirmation. Limpopo is a proposal choice informed by Telkom's documented rural-Limpopo ICT-lab example, not a confirmed funding location.

Target beneficiaries
Proposed: disadvantaged secondary-school learners (especially Grades 10-12), out-of-school or unemployed youth, educators and nearby community members, with intentional participation by girls and young women; final numbers and eligibility to be agreed with Telkom Foundation.

Proposed outputs and targets

The following are proposed planning targets, not completed results. Final targets should be agreed with the company after baseline assessment, budget confirmation and any required stakeholder permissions.

- PROPOSED TARGET: establish or equip 1 community/school digital-learning hub, subject to site assessment, permissions and Telkom approval.
- PROPOSED TARGET: provide basic digital-literacy and online-safety training to 250 learners/youth and 20 educators/community facilitators.
- PROPOSED TARGET: run 12 youth-led community problem-solving or civic-participation sessions and support at least 20 youth-led mini-projects.
- PROPOSED TARGET: deliver 6 career, mentoring or economic-opportunity sessions, including pathways to further learning and ICT-related opportunities.
- PROPOSED TARGET: reach 300 direct participants and track attendance, gender/age/location, pre/post digital-skills change and completed youth/community outputs.
- PROPOSED TARGET: submit a short monitoring, safeguarding and financial report to the funder; all targets remain subject to baseline validation, budget and approval.

Expected outcomes

- Improved community participation and practical public-benefit action in the selected location.
- Improved access to relevant learning, environmental, inclusion, humanitarian or youth-development support, depending on the project design.
- Documented implementation evidence, beneficiary participation and lessons for continuation or scale-up.
- Clear accountability through expenditure records, activity updates, monitoring information and a close-out report.

Why this matters

The proposed intervention responds to a community-development need through the sequence **community need → practical intervention → measurable result**. The final baseline will verify the specific need, beneficiary profile, site conditions, permissions and appropriate indicators before implementation.

ASCO will avoid overstating the problem or claiming results in advance. Where waste, participation, learning, environmental condition, referrals or other outputs are measurable, ASCO will use simple evidence tools such as attendance registers, baseline/endline checks, activity logs, photographs with consent, beneficiary feedback and expenditure records.

> **Evidence discipline:** All numbers in this proposal are either company-reported context from official sources or clearly labelled ASCO planning targets. No completed result, partnership or funding commitment is claimed.

Why Telkom Foundation?

ASCO's approved public-benefit work as a South African NPC can cautiously be framed as complementary to Telkom Foundation priorities if the proposal is education- and technology-led: a community digital-inclusion and youth-participation project could support underserved learners/youth with practical digital literacy, civic/community problem-solving, mentoring and pathways to opportunities. A rural or underserved school/community model in South Africa would resemble the Foundation's documented connected-school and ICT-lab approach. This is thematic alignment only; no partnership, endorsement, funding commitment or fit with Telkom's internal selection process is established.

Verified company context

- Telkom Foundation is Telkom SA SOC Ltd's CSI vehicle, an autonomous legal entity with an independent Board of Trustees; its stated focus is uplifting communities in need through sustainable development programmes.
- Its mandate and mission centre on disadvantaged-community transformation through youth education and skills development, ICT integration in schools, STEM education, digital literacy, digital skills and psychosocial support linked to economic opportunities, primarily in ICT.
- The Foundation's education work targets basic education, connected schools, teacher development and learner support in mathematics, science and English, with a Connected Schools programme for underserved communities.
- The FY2026 Annual Report describes community development, digital inclusion and education programmes; its ICT Integration Programme target was 14,562 learners and teachers plus 1,800 youth. These are Telkom Foundation report targets, not ASCO commitments.
- The Foundation operates in South Africa. An official 16 May 2025 release documents an ICT lab in rural Limpopo, with stated direct annual beneficiaries of more than 350 Grade 10-12 learners and 25 educators, plus surrounding-community engagement; this is an example of prior work, not a promise of funding.
- Telkom's sustainability approach identifies investing with purpose, digital services and empowered communities, including digital literacy and affordable/inclusive digital connectivity, as social priorities.

Company facts are drawn from official sources reviewed for this proposal. They describe public priorities or reported company activity; they are not promises of funding to ASCO.

Indicative project budget

The requested amount is allocated transparently across delivery and accountability categories. The budget is indicative and should be refined with the company after the implementation site, beneficiary profile, quotations and eligible-cost rules are confirmed.

Budget category	Indicative amount	Use
Direct programme implementation	R60,000	Core activities, local delivery inputs and community implementation for the proposed project.
Participant transport and access	R8,000	Reasonable access support to enable participation, subject to eligibility and records.
Safety equipment and participant welfare	R6,000	PPE, first aid, safeguarding, water/refreshments and safe participation requirements.
Educational and mobilisation materials	R8,000	Learning resources, community mobilisation and accessible communication.
Monitoring, evaluation and reporting	R7,000	Baseline, attendance, outcome tracking, documentation and close-out reporting.
Volunteer/project coordination	R7,000	Scheduling, volunteer support, stakeholder coordination and implementation management.
Reasonable administration	R4,000	Reasonable project administration directly attributable to delivery; no inflated overheads.
Total requested CSI investment	**R100,000**	**Equals the proposed request.**

Administration is limited to a reasonable project share. ASCO will not promise audited financial statements unless they are available; it will provide appropriate project expenditure records and supporting documentation.

Partnership options

Option A — Full project funding
Company funds the proposed project at R100,000, subject to approval and agreement.

Option B — Partial project funding
Company contributes a defined portion of the budget, with scope and outputs adjusted transparently.

Option C — Multi-phase partnership
Company supports a pilot followed by an agreed continuation or scale-up phase based on evidence.

In-kind or technical support
Where relevant, equipment, expertise, access or employee volunteering may complement cash support, subject to written agreement.

Accountability and reporting

ASCO will maintain appropriate records relating to funded activities and can provide, subject to agreed requirements:

- Project implementation updates
- Expenditure records and supporting documentation
- Attendance and participation information where appropriate and lawfully collected
- Photographs and activity evidence with appropriate consent
- Safeguarding and incident records where relevant
- Monitoring and outcome information
- Activity and close-out reports

ASCO will agree reporting frequency, eligible costs, procurement expectations, data protection, branding, acknowledgement and any site-access or technical requirements before implementation. Any use of company branding or recognition will be subject to written approval.

Initial contact route

Official contact listed in the FY2026 Annual Report: telkom.foundation@telkom.co.za; Tel: +27 12 311 2186; registered office The Hub, 61 Oak Avenue, Highveld Park, Centurion, 0157, Private Bag X780 Pretoria 0001, South Africa. The reviewed official pages did not show a current public application portal or published proposal form; contact the Foundation to ask about the current CSI proposal route and requirements.

ASCO welcomes an initial discussion to confirm whether the proposed project is within the company's current CSI/ESG remit, whether unsolicited proposals are accepted, what documents are required, and whether the full, partial or in-kind partnership option is most suitable.

Important conditions and open questions

- The sources do not publish a current open grant application form, formal eligibility checklist, funding-cycle timetable or guarantee that unsolicited proposals are accepted; confirm these directly before submission.
- The Foundation's mandate and described programmes are strongly education/ICT-focused. A proposal framed mainly as general civic activity, without measurable digital inclusion, youth skills, learner/teacher support or community-development outcomes, may be a weaker fit.
- No public source reviewed confirms that the Foundation funds external South African NPCs at the requested amount, pays unrestricted costs, or supports every proposed geography or beneficiary type.
- ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

- The FY2026 Annual Report reports Telkom Foundation activities and targets for its own reporting period; those figures must not be represented as ASCO results or guaranteed future outputs.
- No existing ASCO-Telkom relationship, partnership, completed result or company commitment is claimed.

These cautions are included to prevent overstatement. They should be resolved with the company before ASCO treats the proposal as eligible or finalises a submission budget.

Closing

ASCO believes meaningful social and environmental progress is achieved through collaboration between communities, civil society and responsible corporate partners. We invite **Telkom Foundation** to join us in delivering measurable public-benefit impact through a carefully scoped and accountable partnership.

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Official sources and verification links

Important company and programme information in this proposal was checked against the following official sources:

1. https://group.telkom.co.za/telkomfoundation/who-we-are.html
2. https://group.telkom.co.za/telkomfoundation/how-we-help.html
3. https://group.telkom.co.za/documents/telkomfoundation/annual-reports/TelkomFoundation-Annual-Report-FY2026.pdf
4. https://group.telkom.co.za/sustainability/our-approach.html
5. https://group.telkom.co.za/about-us/mediacentre/currentreleases/2025/Telkom-ActivelyBridging-the-DigitalDivide-for-SouthAfricas-Youth-20250516.html

Source review and proposal preparation date: October 2026. Company information and application routes can change; ASCO should confirm current requirements before submission.